

# HARLAN T WOOD

FOUNDER / AI ENGINEER / FULL STACK DEVELOPER



## SUMMARY

- US citizen available for remote-first contract/part time/full time | Pacific or Eastern US hours
- 20+ years software development experience across AI, blockchain, and decentralized systems
- Proven track record of developer productivity improvements through innovative tooling and AI integration
- Expert technical leader who builds high-performing teams while staying hands-on with code
- Champion of engineering excellence through test automation, CI/CD optimization, and cutting-edge practices
- Polyglot developer who bridges emerging technologies with practical solutions

“ If Harlan Wood is seeking to work his magic for you, and you decide to go forward, simply put, you will never regret it. He is a person of enormous character, vitality, and warmth, with vast technical talent, extensive creative gifts, and the **discipline and impact of a seasoned master**. A person of this stature makes all the difference in a pioneering technical effort. ”

— Jim McCarthy, author, Dynamics of Software Development (Microsoft Press)

## EXPERIENCE

- 2026 | 2025
  - **Lead AI Engineer** Union Remote
    - Engineered real-time AI voice calling using VAPI, integrating transcription models, LLMs, and custom webhook handlers with seamless tool calling—enabling natural conversations without noticeable latency.
    - Led the design and implementation of a comprehensive AI evaluation framework, introducing eval-driven development to the team. Integrated a custom simulator with Langfuse to run matrix simulations across multiple models and runs, establishing eval as a core development practice.
    - Architected a knowledge graph system that generates nodes and edges from natural language queries, to power PathRAG—an improved context retrieval system that outperforms GraphRAG and traditional RAG approaches.
    - Developed custom AI testing and evaluation tooling, improving our LLM unit test "testbeds" and integration test simulators, while improving internal developer tooling for better readability, usability, and information clarity.
- Current | 2016
  - **Founder & Principal Consultant** Nodesphere Studio Remote
    - Building OpenClaw deployment solutions.
    - Architected AI solutions: LLM integration, real-time voice-to-voice (OpenAI Realtime API), HIPAA-compliant Next.js/React apps
    - Built and deployed open-source AI interviewer system using WASM for enhanced performance and offline capabilities
    - Created the WorkNation prototype for decentralized, cryptographically signed workplace attestations with Cisco, Institute for the Future, and TrustGraph, leveraging UPort on the Ethereum blockchain
- Current | 2012
  - **Technical Cofounder** Superluminal Systems Remote
    - Engineered the Ruby on Rails backend from scratch, establishing a scalable foundation that supported seamless growth and data integration across multiple backend sources
    - Led the front-end and back-end developer teams, ensuring alignment on technical vision and achieving on-time project milestones with a cohesive deployment strategy
    - Owned the entire tech stack and deployment process, optimizing infrastructure with experiments on Fly.io and Cloudflare Workers to enhance performance and reliability
    - Directed AI project development, designing a custom classification system tailored to domain-specific needs, which provided a foundation for future AI advancements
    - Drove research in information visualization, leveraging Three.js and D3 to build dynamic data representations that enhanced user engagement and data accessibility
    - Implemented Stripe integration and streamlined subscription migration, improving user and admin experience simultaneously
- 2024 | 2018
  - **Principal Architect / Tech Lead** SharesPost / Forge Global Remote
    - Led development team, implementing GitHub Codespaces from scratch to reduce developer environment setup time from days to minutes, boosting team productivity and expediting new developer onboarding
    - Directed the complete migration of CI/CD pipelines from CircleCI to GitHub Actions, cutting build times, reducing operational costs, and streamlining workflow management
    - Spearheaded the adoption of Kubernetes and Tilt for reproducible, multi-cloud infrastructure, enabling seamless project deployments across diverse cloud environments and enhancing system resilience

## CONTACT INFO

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☎ +1.808.868.9749  
📍 Azores

## SKILLS

- OpenClaw
- GraphRAG / PathRAG
- Knowledge Graphs
- AI Evals
- AI Developer Tools
- Realtime Voice AI
- Agentic AI
- AI Image/Video
- TypeScript
- Ruby/Rails
- SQL
- Svelte
- React
- Python
- Rust
- Elixir
- Pedantic CI / CD
- Software Quality
- Tech Architecture
- Dev Productivity
- Test Automation
- System Design
- Tech Leadership
- Dev Mentorship

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|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 2017<br> <br>2016 | <b>Cofounder &amp; CTO</b><br>Upside <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Built the code base from scratch, establishing a high-quality, well-tested infrastructure that became the foundation of a company that has received millions of dollars in funding, and is currently profitable</li> <li>• Architected and integrated ERC-20 token functionality, enabling seamless blockchain transactions within the platform</li> <li>• Built and managed servers for Ethereum nodes, ensuring reliable and decentralized access to blockchain resources</li> <li>• Led the architecture and implementation of a digital startup equity tracking system, providing secure and reliable infrastructure for managing startup equity</li> </ul> | 📍 Remote                   |
| 2016<br> <br>2014 | <b>Staff Engineer</b><br>Citizen Code <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Led the tech team for American Express' skunkworks blockchain project inception, simultaneously building out open-source TrustGraph libraries to advance decentralized trust networks</li> <li>• Collaborated with Nasdaq Private Markets to design and develop a trading system, delivering scalable infrastructure tailored to private market needs</li> <li>• Practiced full-time Extreme Programming, incorporating TDD and pair programming to ensure high-quality, resilient code across client projects</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                      | 📍 Remote                   |
| 2012<br> <br>2010 | <b>Director of Engineering / Senior Developer</b><br>Zoji <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Directed a team culture that balanced software craftsmanship with business-driven deadlines, ensuring high-quality output aligned with strategic goals</li> <li>• Contributed hands-on to full-stack development using Ruby on Rails, RSpec, JavaScript, jQuery, and Jasmine, with TDD and pair programming throughout</li> <li>• Designed and implemented systems for automated server deployment; screened and interviewed developer candidates to maintain a high-caliber engineering team</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                   | 📍 San Francisco, CA        |
| 2010<br> <br>2006 | <b>Selected Earlier Experience</b><br>Planet Metrics · Internaut Design (LinkedIn) · Wireless Generation <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Full-stack Rails development with XP/Lean/Agile practices; led retrospectives and continuous improvement (Planet Metrics)</li> <li>• Developed significant new functionality for LinkedIn's core website; led project management with visual feedback (Internaut Design)</li> <li>• Initiated department-wide unit testing, CI, and Selenium automation; mentored junior developers (Wireless Generation)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                        | 📍 San Francisco / New York |



EDUCATION

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                     |
|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 2006 | <b>Bachelor of Science, Computer Science (First Class Honors)</b><br>University of Technology, Sydney <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Computer graphics submajor: 3D game engine in C++/OpenGL, raytracer in C#</li> </ul> | 📍 Sydney, Australia |
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CONFERENCES

|      |                                                |                     |
|------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 2024 | AI Engineering Worlds Fair                     | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2024 | World AI Summit                                | 📍 Austin, TX        |
| 2023 | Decentralized Web Camp                         | 📍 Camp Navarro, CA  |
| 2022 | Decentralized Web Camp                         | 📍 Camp Navarro, CA  |
| 2021 | Decentralized Web Camp                         | 📍 Camp Navarro, CA  |
| 2019 | RailsConf                                      | 📍 Minneapolis, MN   |
| 2019 | Code BEAM (Elixir & Erlang)                    | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2019 | Decentralized Web Camp                         | 📍 Pescadero, CA     |
| 2018 | Rebooting the Web of Trust                     | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2018 | ElixirConf                                     | 📍 Seattle, WA       |
| 2018 | Decentralized Web Summit                       | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2017 | Rebooting the Web of Trust                     | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2017 | Crypto-Consciousness Conference                | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2016 | Rebooting the Web of Trust                     | 📍 San Francisco, CA |
| 2016 | Decentralized Web Summit: Locking the Web Open | 📍 San Francisco, CA |